Workplace Communication — Exam revision sheet

1. Communication

Communication is the exchange of information, ideas, or feelings between a sender and a receiver. It is effective when the receiver correctly understands the sender's intended meaning.

2. Misunderstanding Gap

The sender's intention may differ from what they say and what the receiver understands. Example: “Finish this ASAP” can be interpreted as today or tomorrow.

3. Language and non-verbal cues

Clear, appropriate terminology reduces confusion. Facial expressions, gestures and body language also affect communication.

4. Five components

Source → Message → Channel → Receiver → Feedback
Source: sender. Message: information. Channel: method (email, speech, phone). Receiver: person interpreting the message. Feedback: receiver's response to the source.

5. Barriers

Environmental: noise and distractions. Language: unclear terms or jargon. Psychological: stress or inattention. Contextual: misunderstood tone or situation. Intermediaries: details changed or omitted by a middleman.

6. Consequences

Conflicts, damaged relationships, wasted resources, inefficiency, missed opportunities and lower productivity.

7. Improve communication

Use clear language, listen actively, ask clarifying questions, choose the right channel, and exchange feedback.
Exam takeaway: Successful communication depends on what the receiver understands, not simply what the sender says.